

Patterns in Play — Module 03: Perception — Think About It

Part A: Family Discussion Questions

1. Why is Peek-a-Boo fun for babies but not for older kids? (Babies are surprised every time — older kids predict the face will come back).
2. What makes Hide-and-Seek exciting? (The tension of not knowing — will they find me?).
3. Why do surprise parties feel so good? (A big positive prediction error!).
4. What happens when a game becomes too predictable? (It gets boring — no more surprise).
5. How do you "read the room" during a game? (Noticing if people are having fun or getting frustrated).
6. Why is it harder to find something when you do not know what it looks like?
7. What senses do you use most during games? (Sight for board games, hearing for music games, touch for building).
8. Can you trick someone's perception in a game? (Like a feint in sports, or bluffing in cards).
9. Why are magic tricks fun? (The magician creates a prediction error — you expected one thing and saw another!).
10. What is "Paying Attention"? Why is it a skill you can get better at?

Part B: Hands-On Activities and Reflection

1. Play Peek-a-Boo with different family members. Who laughs the most? Why? (Younger children are more surprised because their prediction skills are still developing).
2. Play Hide-and-Seek but track your predictions: Before looking, guess where you think the person is hiding. Were you right? Your brain is making predictions!
3. Make a "Surprise Jar": Write surprises on slips of paper (a funny joke, a silly dance, a small treat). Pull one each day. Track: Were you surprised?

4. Play a guessing game: One person thinks of an animal. Others ask yes/no questions.
Each answer narrows the prediction. How many questions does it take?
5. Do a "Spot the Difference" activity with two similar pictures. Your brain must compare its prediction of one image with the reality of the other.
6. Play "Freeze Tag" — when you are frozen, you must stay perfectly still and observe.
What do you notice when you are watching instead of running?
7. Set up a simple magic trick (hide a coin under a cup, shuffle cups). Try to fool your family. Discuss: How did the trick work? (Misdirecting perception!).
8. Go on a "Nature Perception Walk": Walk outside and try to notice five things you have never noticed before (a bird, a pattern, a texture). New perceptions mean new data for your brain!
9. Play "What Changed?": One person leaves the room. The others change one thing.
When the person returns, can they spot the change?
10. Before bed, play the "Three Sounds" game: Everyone closes their eyes and listens. Each person names three sounds they hear. Were they the same sounds or different? Our brains filter differently.